MCM 202 - Lecture 4: Fact-Checking in Journalism - Why Editors Must Verify Everything

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Transcript 1

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Lesson Video

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Transcript

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Transcript Text

We are Five. All right. Good afternoon everyone. I hope you're all doing well. You're welcome to this session. The cost of one error. Imagine a news report is published stating that a university has just received a 500 million in funding and within an hour in fact maybe stretch of two or three hours the story spread across social media. Students celebrated and administrator responded. Public expectation rise. The next day a correction is issued and the actual figure figure was just 50 million naira.

Not a small mistake, a zero too many. But by then the misinformation has spread. Trust has been weakened. The credibility of the media organization is questioned. This is the reality of editing. One unchecked detail can distort reality. Today we're focusing on a simple thing, an editor's most important responsibility, which is not grammar, but securing the truth. You're welcome to this session. Okay. Now, I've introduced you to what we'll be looking at today. But then, let me be very specific about our expectations and what I should expect from you. Again, if you want to connect with me on a personal note, this me. And then it's time for us to check in. Check in quick. Check in. Check in quick.

All right. If you have checked in, you've just done the writing. Well done. Let's go. So, today we're going to cover accuracy in editing. We're going to look at factchecking techniques and I'll be guiding you through style guards and consistency and eliminating bias and ambiguity in reports. So we also focus on practical editing applications like I've previously introduced in another course which I'm going to reference in the description that is MCN 202 206 sorry apologies. So this is 202. All right. Now by the end of this session I expect that you'll be able to explain how content moves through the newsroom and you'll be able to identify the role of a sub editor apply basic editing and pro reading symbols.

Understand how editing decisions shape final output and let's move on. What makes editing advanced? Put it in the chat. What makes editing advanced? What makes editing advanced? If you tried the checking earlier and it's not working, give it another shot. Give it another shot. Oh. Okay. What makes editing advanced? What makes editing advanced? No. What makes it advanced is not by serious technical issues. And it's important for you to think think about it this way. Is grammatical correct sentence always a good sentence? Is grammatical correct sentence always a good sentence? Okay, the checkin is working now. Is grammatical correct sentence always a good sentence? All

right, I'm just going to bounce back to the checkin page for you guys to be sure that you are using the right link. Okay, I've start receiving response which signifies that it is working. It is working. All right, so let's come back here. Check in, check in, check in. All right. I've had an experience before which sort of taught me that we need to be very patient when you are editing. As communicators, we need to be careful about how we communicate and what we let out. What we let out. We need to be very sensitive about what we let out. So it's important that we provid we double check we triple check content before letting it fly because whenever we don't what happens eventually is that we lose credibility we lose reputation and people will no longer trust you.

So you want to be sure that anything that is that you're opening your mouth even as an individual there are things that you're proud of there are things that you can defend there are things that you have no reason to you know to revert and even if you want to revert it will be sensible understandable and and of course something people will say it's it's they can pass as all right it's just a human error and human error can be minimized and how can you minimize human error you can minimize error human error by worth by ensuring that you put in professional effort into what you're doing okay so I can confirm that the checkin is working so please do well to check in. I can confirm that it is working. Oh, it's back again to not working states. I've reverted it again, please. For some reasons, I think is the traffic on it. So, keeps checking in.

I can receive more response. Keep checking in. All right. So, I'm going to continue the lesson. All right. So now moving on, let's begin what we focusing. What makes editing advanc? Is it the grammatical correctness of a sentence or is it use of big languages, jagons, and more? What makes it advanced? Put it in the chat. Put it in the chat. What makes it advance? What makes it advance? What makes it advance? And I'm putting it to you. Is a grammatically correct sentence always a good sentence? If it is grammatically correct, doesn't mean it is a good sentence. Doesn't mean it is perfect. Some things are grammatically correct, but they may not be appropriate. for the audience that is being channelneled to us.

Okay, let's move on. Now, you're moving beyond grammar. You're moving beyond punctuations. You're moving beyond syntax. Now, you're looking at context. You're focusing on truth. You're focusing on clarity. You're focusing on fairness. These are the things that advanced editing takes care of. Advanced editing goes beyond grammar. It improve the key aspect of things. Things that can get you into irredeem irredeemable trouble. And you are making editorial decisions not just corrections. You

are trying to be the leader seeing the picture miles ahead beyond what even the reporter may see. You're looking at the legal implication.

You're looking at the ethical implication. You're looking at the brand and the image of your organization. That is what you're looking at. What are the principles of the accuracy? We mentioned something about truth clarity and fairness. Under truth, it has to be accurate. So what are the principle of accuracy? Principle of accuracy includes that every fact must be correct. The names, the dates, the figures and the location, they must be verifiable and be verified. So some errors damage cred credibility. You don't want to make an error that will damage your credibility. So be careful about that. Example, for example, look at this. Federal government allocates 3 million naira to education sector.

This does it look correct to you? Federal government allocates 3 million naira to education sector. Does it look correct? Now look at this. Federal government allocate 3 billion naira to education sector. Which one looks correct? Remember the contest we provided earlier. Billion is different from million. A single letter can change everything. The only thing that change between these two sentences is M and B. Billion. Million. So you need to be sure about what you're saying. Okay. Now let's take a look at some facteing fundamentals as an editor. Now when we're talking about this in the context of editing and graphics you see the journalist might have done the writing reporter might have done the writing in fact the sub editor might have done the writing the line editor would have done the beat editor would have the editor himself could have done the writing and it now gets to the

graphic editor and the graphic editor maybe in the course of typing deleted or changed million to billion or deleted an S from from from a particular instead of facts he wrote facts because he was arranging edit maybe in the course of adjusting headline and sizing and then reducing font and increasing font or he mystically inserted a word in between as a graphic person that can change the entire meaning of the text that is why even after editing there's what they call proof reading proof reading comes after layout has been done. Michael affirmation said sharp actively engaged continues to be engaged. So you need to process every bit of data, every bit of information ensure that they are correct and they should be verifiable before publication. What are the things you have to check? Check the correct spelling of names.

Just today someone who have been continuously exposed to a name. I asked same person to spell or search something about a person and they were unable to search. They were unable to spell correctly. So you cannot be learning and not apply. Check out for names. Check out for dates. Check out for statistics. Check out for quotes. Check out for sources. Okay. Now, fact checking. There are some techniques you can apply. How do you verify information? Cross check multiple sources. Check across different platforms. Don't just stick to one. Don't just ask chibi. Don't just ask any other kind of AI model. Don't just put it on Google. Google itself has its own AI now that responds in summary.

Don't rely on that. About two weeks ago, is it up to two weeks? Yes. Up about two weeks ago, I was speaking at Fact Check Africa and I asked them what is the big which is the biggest library in the world. They Googled it. It gave them a library of Congress in the United States, which is factually wrong. That's what AI said. But do a fun digging. Simple Wikipedia will give you the right start. So don't rely on everything you see as a search result. They are not always correct. And in fact I can tell you information the most majority of information consumed by Africans are usually false information mal information. Okay. Some of them misinformation and some of them disinformation.

Cross check multiple sources to confirm. Use official data sources. Yes, please don't depend on artificial intelligence. Even when you're giving editing tasks, do not rely on artificial intellig. Do your part and you can query AI to validate what you're doing. And its own validation is not the final. Don't let AI become your master. Let it remain a tool when you use. Now you can confirm quotes, you can confirm attribution. Okay? Avoid assumptions. You see this part of quote and attribution. Please when someone is to be quoted, ensure it is their precise word. Otherwise, if you quote out of context, you can get into trouble. Avoid assumptions.

Assumption is the lowest form of knowledge. Stay away from it. Yes. Now, common fact errors includes and the typical mistake that we often encounter. They are wrong figures, misqued statements,

incorrect names or title, outdated information. For example, AI are trained on models on on data. If for example, the last time it was trained, the charge you're using perhaps the last time it was trained was last year July, it means it has a gap between last year and now. It doesn't have up to date information. You have to be aware that AI is drawing from somewhere and if that data bank is empty or void or has a gap that gap becomes a gap that automatically you're fed with fed from if I don't have salt at home and I prepare food for you be ready to eat saltless food and if you are not wise enough to know that something is said you don't have a good

sense of taste and you think you'll be fine you'll be all right. Anyway, so now there are different kind of salts. Let me give another example. There's sea salt, table salt, cooking salt. If you don't know the difference between this kind of salt, if I use any of them to cook for you, you won't know. So you need to be able to know the sauce. When they use sea salt, you should know. So the only way you can know is for you to what? Be exposed. rich, be sharp. You understand me? All right, let's take a look at this question. What is the primary purpose of factecking in editing? Don't just pick the option, write a statement. The purpose of facteing in editing is don't just pick an option.

Is it to improve sentence length? Is it to ensure information is correct and verifiable? Is it to make headline more attractive? Is it to reduce writing time? Put it in the chat as a full sentence. Don't just say a b blah blah blah. Try to train yourself to do the right thing at the right time. I understand it might be smart to just pick an option. This is not a motivated mark sheets. It's not AMS question. You're writing to engage. Let your thoughts be full. Train yourself to express yourself and add reasons for your answers. All right. Now the answer is B because in order to ensure information is correct that's why we need factchecking.

Now why style matters? Let's talk about styles and consistency. I I remember as an undergraduate student I was asked to read strong and white. and that is element of styles. Element of styles by strong and white. If you have heard about this now, please search for it. Element of size strangle that that book is a they call it the little book. Yes, I believe I I think is a little book. It transformed my writing style. So style matters because it helps you ensure uniformity across content. It helps you to improve readability. It helps you reflect on professionalism. It helps you to do these three things well. And this happens across content. When you have a style, you have a strategy.

When you have a style, you have a voice. When you have a style, you're known for your style. When you have a style, you have a tone. And your tone is what distinct you from others. They don't just appoint people randomly. They appoint them based on what they can offer. Ask yourself, what unique skills do I have to offer? When I'm putting my CV across the counter, across the the upload button, you know, across emails, what unique thing am I selling? What makes me stand out amongst multiple of other applicants? What would make them shortlist me and not shortlist them? What is your style? How professional are you? What is your unique selling point? As a journalist, communication professionals in training. Some of you work with government, you work with private, you even start organization of your own. You need to ensure that you have a style. Style matters.

All right. Thank you. And your style attracts specific kind of audience that you attract and those people for some reason become loyalists to your writing style because they like you. They are drawn to you because of that. So let's take a look at some other element of styles. We have capitalization is an element of style. There are different ways policies can be made. Some people some organization can decide how they want to use capitalization. Some people can decide to say how they have policy around using numbers and figures. They have policy around using date and time. Some write date for example as Friday, the month, the the date, and then the year.

Some people use numbers, some people use the date before the month and then the year. You know, different styles. abbreviations some know the standard English way of doing abbreviation is that if you writing MCM as an abbreviation which is mass communication I should have M do C dot M but some people decide to strip off the dot it becomes a style but ordinarily every abbreviation should have a dot to show that it is an abbreviation okay Let's talk about inconsistencies in style. Look at this word. Nigerian government. Who is Nigerian government? Federal government. Who is federal government? FG. Now, can you see that there is no standard? If I have used these three different things in a in a story, the point will be that I'm not consistent with my terms. I'm not consistent

with my style. So, you need to be consistent.

Pick one and stick to it. If you are using FG, ensure that you have explained what FG is from the beginning or be sure that your audience know what FG is. Nigerian government, what part of the government? Is it the state, federal, which? Okay. Now, standardizing inconsistent terms is very important. Don't miss that. All right. Let's take a look at how to we can eliminate ambiguity clarity in meaning. You know sometimes you we communicate and then you are ambiguous in sentence. For example, students discussed issues with teachers. The question will be what what were the what were the issues? Who has the issues? What exactly is this issue about? So we need to be sure that we are clear about what issue is being discussed.

Now to my next point is removing bias. Removing bias is about editorial neutrality. Editorial neutrality. Editorial neutrality. Now what is editorial neutrality? You need to ensure that your objective you you disconnect from the story and you present it the way it should be. If I say the government failed again to fix education problems, what does that mean? Is it that's biased? Because I already have a position. It will be appropriate for me to say the government has not resolved ongoing education challenges. Now I want to ask you to rewrite this in your own way. Rewrite it in your own way. Try this and attempt it in your own way. Try to make that first sentence neutral. In what other ways can you write this? I'm just going to take it back.

What other ways can you write this to remove bias? What other way can you approach to remove violence? All right. Thanks for making that attempt. All right. Now, let's move on. Talk about ethical editing. Ethics in editing. Avoid distortion of facts. Maintain fairness. Respect sources. Respect sources. Very important. It's important that you respect sources. If they want to keep something confidential, keep it confidential. Avoid distortion of the fact that they've provided to you. Maintain fairness. Now, let's look at this flawed tax accuracy.

And I'm going to give you ample of time. I'm going to leave you with this for about 10 minutes. Yes, 10 minutes. Get on on this tax right. Correct the ambiguity. What you're looking out for? You're looking for incorrect data. You're looking for ambiguous data. And you're looking for bias. So get on with this. You've got 10 minutes starting now. Okay, I see that you guys are yet to get here. It's going to take you some time. I want you to look at every line. Look at each of the lines. Look at each of the sentences, phrases. If you need to rewrite, rewrite. But do this and do it right. your whatever answer you are writing en sure you save it personally save it on your listen I'm going to provide a link later where you're going to send it to so please focus and do this do it carefully and do it correctly you're looking out for incorrect data so it means you have

to do some factchecking online you're looking out for ambiguity and you're you're going to fact check anything that is not clear. You're looking out for biases in this statement. It's going to take you some time. It's going to take you some time. So, I'll extend that 10 minutes to 15 minutes. Get on with it. Another thing you can do is to respond also back to yourself. Respond to something that you picked from another person that you think is wrong. react to somebody else post. React to somebody else post on what you think they might have done wrongly or what they have done correctly and ensure that you have your own full write up as a paragraph saved on your on on a word document with you.

So ensure you do that. Okay. Now I'm going to keep the screen at full screen so you can focus. So, how is it going? I can see a lot of effort that has gone into this. I can see a lot of effort that has gone into this. Okay. Am I Are you ready to see the answer? Are you Are you curious? Are you eager to find out if you're right or wrong? Let me know. Or should I give you more time? Do you need more time? If you want more time, say more time.

More time or it is okay. Yes sir. Yes sir. If I can see if there's any more. Yes sir. I'll go ahead. All right. So before I unveil it, let's try this. What is the first priority in advanced editing? Is it style? Is it speed? Is it accuracy? Is it design? What is the first priority in advanced editing? I can see a few of you have gotten a grip of some of these things. Accuracy. Accuracy. Let's find out. Could accuracy be the right answer? Correct. It is accuracy. All right. Let's do this. I'm going to provide you with a short article again and then I'm expecting you to identify the most inaccurate aspect of that particular article. So now there's going to be an article and what I'm

going to do is to Okay, I think Oh yeah, I've put my This is meant to come before that.

Apologies for that. Okay, this was meant to come right before this. Okay, let's go on. So the article I've pro provided is this. and I want you to look at it. It is intentionally flawed. Intentionally flawed. And I want you to look at it. Yeah, this is ethical. It's correct. Okay. Now, it is intentionally flawed. is different from the one you did earlier which is which is the practice. This one this is different from this. So now this article I want you to identify the possible inaccuracies the missing verification points in there. Oh, the missing verification point in there and then you can put it in the chart. So, here is the work. Do it. I think I've gotten some interesting

feedback there. Someone said that almost 85% of this article is wrong. Now you have to pick up the wrong. I'm looking out for Doras Sim's next comments. Okay. Now we go to Peter Miracle said there are many global reports that ranks university. The particular one should have been stated for clarity. That is correct. Well done. Okay. Los State University is not ranked as number one university. The university has not received any 200 billion in funding from federal government. So that's another another one. Have I That's correct. That's a good one. The claims are wrong. But now don't just tell me it is wrong. You need to fix it.

Fix it. Fix it. You need to find solutions to it. Suggest ways how it can be improved. Okay? Suggest ways how it can be improved. Suggest ways how it can be improved. Okay, now I'm going to Okay, possible inaccuracies. Number one, university in Africa. No widely no not what is not widely recognized as global ranking places. Lass this is an unverified claim. Okay, that is another very good point there. Lasso recently ranked as the number one in Africa. Inaccuracy. Okay, there are no verified global ranking that place Lasso as number one in Africa. So it means missing verification. So another says over according to the report over 95% of G from university have secured employment. This is wrong.

So that's another good point. Lagos State University has not been ranked number one in the Africa. The statistics of funding and student confirmation are wrong. So some words are not capitalized. That's another editorial issue. So unverified claims are also there. Okay. So let me know when you're ready for the answer. You can put it there. I'm ready to see. I'm ready to see. So I'm ready to share what I expected from you guys. You guys have done very good work there. Legos university is not number one in Africa. Yes, that is corre I don't know about that. So the stats and reports stating that 95% are you must not say anything that you know that's that's bias maybe bias except if you have data to support that. Okay.

So now be very sure that you're sharing the correct information given the current economic climate and unemployment rate in Nigeria. is practically impossible for any university let alone public one with thousands of graduates yearly. Okay, that's a good point there. That's a good point there. Okay. Whoa. All right. So, we have good we're having good conversation. I'm very proud of you guys. Well done. Well done. Well done. Okay. All right, you're ready. I can I'm waiting for more readiness. Okay. Another said according to reports he said is vague. Yes, it is unverified. a pro a particle a proper article should name sources. Okay. P behind me.

I suspected that you have used AI there. Well done. Anyway, it's good that you use AI to verify it. It's not bad. It's okay. So, but it's also good for you to engage yourself there, you know, and claims are not attributed properly in the article. That's correct. And there are many global report that ranks university. This particular one should have been stated clearly. That's correct. That is correct. Absolutely correct. Absolutely correct. Okay, I can see more response coming. So, I'm just going to wait. All right, you're ready. You're ready.

You're ready. Let's go. All right. Are you sure you're ready? Let's take this question. Which of the following is wrong indicator that a statement may be unreliable? Which of the following is the is a strong indicator that a statement may be unreliable? Is it includes specific dates? It is supported by official sources. It uses vague phrases like according to reports. It includes names of institution from the previous tax. You should have an idea of what the answer is. Okay. Okay. You having more? All right. Keep your answers coming. Let's see if anybody will get it wrong. Everybody is saying see. The claims are wrong. So the facts are not verified.

Vague phrases according to reports over 95%. Yeah. Yeah. Yes. It has been supported the vague phrases. Yeah. All right. The answer will be it uses vague phrases like according to report because the report needs to be mentioned if you if the writer is actually sure. Now have a look at this. This is the correct this. I want you to mark yourself. Mark yourself. No. Now mark yourself. If you are correct, can you say correct? Like I got most of it. Can you mark yourself? Remember this was where we're coming from and I want you to take note of something here. There are some possible inaccuracies. The number one inaccuracy in this is that there is no source cited.

200 billion NRA funding is very exaggerated and it is unrealistic. Yes, unrealistic given the history and the budget that has budget allocated for education nationally and 95% employment within 3 months. It requires strong evidence and some of the things that are missing could be what you're missing global education reports. which organization released which organization released even the reports where was the fund the funding data came from? Where did it come from? Who confirmed student claims? What are the sources for employment statistics? What are the evidence for the 50 country claims? And there's also the weak use of language in that in this particular thing you're looking at. According to reports, according to reports is is vague is not specific. students have confirmed it is not credible sourcing and recently it lacks specific it has to give us specific time specific frame now I want to ask you which claim is the most dangerous of all of these things which claim is the most dangerous among all of these which one do you think is the most dangerous if it is

published unverified. The second question I want to ask, which statement appears most believable but may still be false? Now, how would you verify one of these claims? Sometimes the most dangerous errors are not obvious. They are not obvious. You really can't tell them easily. They are confidently written falsehood. Now I'm going to I'll just go back to the correction. I want you to have a look. Look at the the phrase that says number one. Number one it can be changed to among leading. Okay. 200 billion in funding. That's dangerous. Yes, that's correct. It's a dangerous statement indeed. All right.

So now it's vague sources were made explicit as weak. You understand? and certainty was replaced with you know evidence-driven awareness which is very important in this particular example. So I want you to take note that good editing does not invent facts it remove false certainty and restores credibility. All right we'll draw to the near end of this particular session. What is the most appropriate editorial response to an unverified statistical claim? Is it to replace it with a confirmed and clearly qualified statement or to remove it completely without review or to publish it with emphasis or ignore it if it sound correct? Try this. I'll treat myself to a cup of juice while you are attempting that anyone that gets it right, we share cup with me.

Okay. Oh, C publishes it with emphasis. boy, you're super going to get to trouble if you publish it with emphasis. Okay, the answer is A. I think majority are having a A. A. The answer is A. All right. So today's lesson we've been able to, you know, talk about truth and talking about editing is about ensuring that is accurate information that the things you're publishing is accurate. Editing is about truth, not just grammar. Facteing is essential. Consistency, improve professionalism. Editors must avoid bias. They must avoid bias. And on this note I would say I'm going to give you a tax an assignment and then you have to look out for five factual issues and then you look for 3, 000 consistency and two ambiguous statements from it.

That particular article will be pushed to you and then you you would be able to do that. For now ask me questions. Ask me questions. I'm looking out for the questions. So, I'll start taking some of the questions that have come in and I've got in now. Oh, sorry. The question pool is not open. So, let's open it now. Yeah, it's now open. Yeah. So, it's open now. Let's do it. Let's do it. Refresh your page. And the question pool is open now. Refresh. Refresh. Refresh. I need a cup of data. Well, this is not data. Yeah.

All right. Let's see what we have. just opening my sheet now. Let's see. to waste pool insert. Who's going to be the first person to ask question? I want juice. blossom. How did you get to see my juice? You add it, Papa. Don't worry. I owe you a cup of juice. Ask me for it. Not a cup. A carton of juice. A pack. Sorry. Not not not a full pack. One one one one bottle of juice. All right. So coming back here. I am still waiting for questions. Waiting. Waiting. Waiting. Waiting. Waiting.

Why? Why? Why is it taking you guys so long? Preferably cold. Interesting. All right.

So in the meantime while you are still here if you if you you're yet to decide on what you want to ask me I would like you I don't it's open here it's open the question pool is open here it's open could you please refresh your link refresh your link it's open it's accepting response Yeah, I can confirm that it's open. Yes, I've gotten one one question. No question. So, I learned how to fact check and I learned style and accuracy. That's a good one from from Deor or something. Yeah, a lot. Thank you, sir. I'm Thank you for appreciating that. I'm glad that I was helpful. So after design and layout and type setting has been done, can editing still take place after production? Before production.

Yes, editing can happen before production and that editing will come after there's proof reading. So when you prove read, you are trying to look at what layout has done. So editing can still come at that point. So another question says that is factchecking is factchecking and proof reading the same? Is factchecking and proof reading the same? Facteing is different from proof reading. Fact checking you are confirming facts. Proof reading you are just checking for errors. Yes. So you need to have been fact checked before pro reading stage. Okay. let's see if there are more questions. Okay. In the I know you guys are already getting tired just as I am myself. So we'll bring this gradually now to an end. Okay, I'm expecting more questions, but

there's none. Okay, let's go. Let's go. Let's move. Let's move. Let's move. It's not accepting again. Really? I'm going to sue Google for this. Oh, that's true. Why is Why Why is it messing up? Sorry about that. This is just something outside of my country. So, I keep Okay, you know what? I'm just going to give it a different row. So, I've got another response. Let's see after 300. Yes. So, yeah, I've got more questions, guys. You guys are impressive. So, can we edit this with our own English? Okay, this is another question here. It says, can we edit this with our own English and understanding? It doesn't mean if it differ from your yes of course you can edit with your own English with your own understanding but as long as it is making sense and that question says that how can I identify the correct errors like inaccuracy ability and bias in writing you have to

know what inaccuracy is what is not I have to fact check you have to read the statement and see is it understandable is it clear and you have to look at it are the element of bias and what you have read that is how you do it you sort of you have to think that how to do and how to go about it. Okay. The next question says that how can we assess the credibility of claims such as ranking funding figures, employment statistics in a report when there are no specific data source available and what are the stand what standards should journalists follow to verify such information before publication. All you can do is to look at the major companies, the major organizations that collect data in these areas and see what statistics they have and when whatever statistics you are using, ensure that you quote them in their original context. Quote them in

their original context. When you quote them in their original context, it helps you avoid issues, trouble, and all of the related. to quote them in their original context. Okay. So to what extent can article be considered accurate if it contains precise figure but lacks verifiable sources? No, it's it is still inaccurate for if as long as you can't verify it. How does this affect journalistic integrity? Of course, I won't trust you if you have misled me in any way. So what techniques help remove ambiguity? writing simple language and ensuring that you are leaving the audience with no questions. Okay. So again, is fact checking and proving the same? No, they are not the same.

Sir, is the style the same as brand? Well, branding is a is the what people think about your style is also part of your brand. So, it's not exactly the same, but it's part of it. Your style, I have a brand. My brand is hola. And now you can see my own style of teaching. So, the style is just part of my brand. meaning that I can deploy my style to to ensure that it is pushing my brand. You understand what I mean? So for example, if I'm doing this this way, it's my my own working way and it's a system that I've built and it's working. So what is the name of the book you recommended that improve your writing style? The name of the book is strong and white.

Strong strong and white. just let me see if I can go elements. Search for put it in the in the Google elements of styles by strong and white. Strong is spelled S T R U N K and white is white color white. So it's a small book and let's see I don't want to infringe on any copyright stuff but

what I'll do is I'm just going to share the front page of the book. Open in a new page. Oh yeah. Let's see if this can work. All right. Big chart. Big chart. Let's see. Paste. Does that work? Okay. This is what I'll do. I'm just going to share the cover of the book so that you have a look of what what if what what the book is like. Save as image. download. Done. And I'll push it to my stream app. And there you have it.

So yeah, this is it. This is what it looks like. That's a strong and white element of styles. That's the the the page. That's what it looks like. in the front of pages. The element of styles. Yeah. The element of styles by strong white. So it's a very good book. Grab it. Well done. Okay. Okay. All right. Wow. I don't know how many of you play that game. So all right. That's the name of the book. Element of styles. In what situation? In a situation where statements were made by someone of prominence. For example, the president and upon per checking the statement was found to be untrue. What do you do as an editor delivering the news? You you quote to the president and of course you say however data or available from the sources contradict what the president has said.

It's as simple as that. So the president is now above the law. So none whatsoever. The lecture was very explanator. Okay. Very explanatory. So another one says that how to eliminate bias of course ensure you're saying the truth no questions no questions I just want to appreciate the way you teach I love your style of teaching thank you very much David for when your encouragement that one word has made my day the rest of you don't appreciate me don't worry okay what's the difference between ambiguous and bias ambiguous is when it is not clear it is it is not you're not you're not straightforward bias is when you are clearly and boldly saying that this is where I belong and I I just doubt this person because I don't want to believe the person. That is bias. It's like one-sided. You're not balanced. You understand what I mean now? So, how can I quickly Oh, that's that question is how can I quickly verify facts from reliable sources without slowing down the editing process? It takes time to do some research. It takes you need to do some

research enough for you to be able to verify facts. So, should abbreviation be capitalized? Yes, absolutation should always be capitalized. Abbrivvation should always be capitalized. What's the difference between editing and factchecking? Editing is the addition and removal of details from a particular content while facteing is ensuring that whatever that remains is accurate. So, I I I appreciate you guys for your active contribution. This is a public evidence that you are you're serious about your learning. So, and I see about 127 people still active right here, which is a good one. If you notice that you can't send in chat immediately on the live chat is because I I slowed it down and I don't want an overwhelming sort of chat.

I want a control thing that that I can I can handle. So what is the difference between editing and factchecking? I think I've answered that. I've answered that. So that has been sorted out. So I have Wow, guys are overwhelming me. Coco, it is not a case of D. Okay. All right. Me too. You want a pack of juice? Oh, did you hear a sound of that? And there's How many of you know that sound? All right. So, can style be the same as brand? No. I've answered that question before. About the assignment, sir. Explain how we go about it. I'm going to send you the text and the instructions. Don't worry about that. Okay. What's the best method in eliminating ambiguity? Just be simple. Keep it short and simple. They call it kiss like kiss. Kiss. Keep it short and simple.

K for keep. I for it. S for short. And S for simple case. Okay. Now, what's the difference between pro and I've answered this question. So, what's the meaning of text alignment? Alignment is the agreement of text. You can align to the left. That's to the right on your screen. Yeah, alignment to the right, alignment to the left, or centralize. I'm going to teach you this later. You'll find out in in the in design sort of editing layout and more. So, I have over 116 questions and I'm just at number 58. Most of them says no question. No question. So yeah I'm just going to stop at some point here you see their questions are too much the thing is that I like questions and the problem is that we have limited time so the thing is that if you don't ask questions you will not know the more question you ask the more you know and I will say ask is standing for a for always s for seek

for knowledge always seek knowledge who screenshot it? All right, let's go back. How can I attribute a source? You have to how can you attribute anything I say? You can say according to blah blah blah you did blah blah blah. So on the 60th question I am saying thank you for joining today's class. I can't answer all the question. I've done 60 out of 120. So that is good. In our next class, we'll

look at photo editing techniques, visual framing and ethics. And I will introduce you to layout design which is parallel to what is happening on in design. You see in design is used in both courses that I'm teaching at the moment in this particular year that is they're available on my YouTube course list which is editing and graphics in communication and manuscript layout and design.

You understand? So do both of them that software is is is is what you need for you to thrive your birthday. Happy birthday to you. Happy birthday to you my students. Go and enjoy your day. So let's check out. precious one. Good. Do you have a question? I'm going to do a full video if we have questions that I've not answered. Let's let's check out. Let's check out. It's time to check out. Let's check out. Let's check out. So guys, I'm just going to keep this screen on. Check out. Check out check out. Once again, this is the the book that I'm recommending for styles. It's simple to read, clear to understand. The in design video is not not is not clear. So, what I'm going to do, I'm going to increase the resolution of the YouTube video.

So, it means you're going to get you spend more data if you want super clear stuff. Oh. To all my students who are live with me here that celebrating birthday shout out to you along Fei Gideon birthday shout out to you. Wishing you guys a long prosperous life and a beautiful year. So please go and enjoy your birthday. Mhm. Go and enjoy your birthday. All right. So check out before you go and enjoy so you don't get into trouble. So wow. Bye-bye everyone and I'll see you yeah I'll see you I'll see you next time. I don't know when. I'll see you next time. If you enjoyed this lesson, do well to share with people, encourage others to learn and also come back to it during exam, after before exam.

And if there are other people who you think may you may find this useful too. Yeah. yeah. All right. So I would say take good care of yourself guys and bye.

Check-out Form: *Not provided*